Day 20 - User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

Practical Task | Sample Banking Application

1. User Story Format

A **User Story** is a short description of a feature from the user's point of view. It explains who needs the feature, what they need, and why they need it.

Format: As a [type of user], I want [some goal] so that [some benefit].

Example: As a bank customer, I want to log in to my banking application so that I can securely access my account.

2. Acceptance Criteria

Acceptance Criteria are clear conditions that a feature must satisfy to be accepted as complete. They help the team and tester understand what should happen.

3. Testable Criteria - Given / When / Then

Given	The starting condition or precondition.
When	The action performed by the user.
Then	The expected result after the action.

How to use it: Write each acceptance condition so that a tester can perform an action and verify a clear expected result.

4. Sample User Stories and Testable Acceptance Criteria

The following examples use a sample banking application. These are practice examples; actual banking rules must follow approved project requirements.

User Story 1 - Customer Login

User Story: As a bank customer, I want to log in to my banking application so that I can securely access my account.

Acceptance Criteria

- The customer can log in using valid registered credentials.
- The application displays an error message when the customer enters invalid credentials.
- The application displays validation messages when required login fields are left blank.
- After successful login, the customer is taken to the account dashboard.

Testable Acceptance Criteria (Given / When / Then)

Scenario 1 - Successful login

```
Given the customer is on the login page and has valid registered credentials
When the customer enters the valid credentials and selects Login
Then the application authenticates the customer and displays the account dashboard
```

Scenario 2 - Invalid credentials

```
Given the customer is on the login page
When the customer enters an incorrect username or password and selects Login
Then the application does not log in the customer and displays an appropriate error message
```

Scenario 3 - Blank required fields

```
Given the customer is on the login page
When the customer leaves a required field blank and selects Login
Then the application displays a validation message and does not submit the login
```

User Story 2 - Balance Enquiry

User Story: As a bank customer, I want to view my account balance so that I can know how much money is available in my account.

Acceptance Criteria

- An authenticated customer can open the Balance Enquiry section.
- The application displays the balance for the customer's selected account.
- The balance is displayed with the correct currency format.
- A customer cannot view another customer's account balance.

Testable Acceptance Criteria (Given / When / Then)

Scenario 1 - View own account balance

```
Given the customer is logged in and has an active bank account
When the customer opens the Balance Enquiry section and selects their account
Then the application displays the balance for that account
```

Scenario 2 - Access another customer's account

```
Given the customer is logged in to the banking application
When the customer attempts to access an account that does not belong to them
Then the application denies access and does not display that account's balance
```

User Story 3 - Fund Transfer

User Story: As a bank customer, I want to transfer money to a beneficiary so that I can send funds to another account.

Acceptance Criteria

- The customer can select or enter an eligible beneficiary and a transfer amount.
- The application accepts a transfer when the details are valid and sufficient funds are available.
- The application does not process a transfer when the available balance is insufficient.
- The application displays a transaction result and reference details after processing.

Testable Acceptance Criteria (Given / When / Then)

Scenario 1 - Successful fund transfer

```
Given the customer is logged in, a valid beneficiary is available, and the account has sufficient funds
When the customer enters a valid amount and confirms the transfer
Then the application processes the transfer and displays a success message with a transaction reference
```

Scenario 2 - Insufficient balance

```
Given the customer is logged in and the account balance is lower than the transfer amount
When the customer attempts to confirm the transfer
Then the application rejects the transfer and displays an insufficient-balance message
```

Scenario 3 - Invalid transfer amount

```
Given the customer is on the Fund Transfer page
When the customer enters an invalid amount, such as zero or a negative value
Then the application displays a validation message and does not process the transfer
```

User Story 4 - Bill Payment

User Story: As a bank customer, I want to pay a bill through my banking application so that I can make payments conveniently.

Acceptance Criteria

- The customer can select an available biller and enter the required bill details.
- The application validates the required bill details before payment.
- The application processes a payment when the details are valid and sufficient funds are available.
- The application displays the payment status and a transaction reference after processing.

Testable Acceptance Criteria (Given / When / Then)

Scenario 1 - Successful bill payment

```
Given the customer is logged in, has selected a valid biller, and has sufficient funds
When the customer enters valid bill details and confirms the payment
Then the application processes the payment and displays a success status with a transaction reference
```

Scenario 2 - Missing required bill details

```
Given the customer is on the Bill Payment page
When the customer leaves a required bill detail blank and selects Continue
Then the application displays a validation message and does not proceed with payment
```

Scenario 3 - Insufficient balance

```
Given the customer has selected a valid biller but has insufficient funds
When the customer confirms the bill payment
Then the application rejects the payment and displays an insufficient-balance message
```

5. Tester Checklist

- Check that each User Story follows the format: As a ... I want ... so that ...
- Check that each Acceptance Criterion is clear, specific and testable.
- Check the positive flow (valid input and successful result).
- Check negative flows (invalid input, missing details or insufficient balance).
- Verify the actual result against the expected result and report any mismatch as a defect.

Task Completed: Four sample banking user stories have been written with acceptance criteria and Given / When / Then test scenarios.